One of the main tasks of the DS was to organize the forward area tours and then conduct the war game specific to that command. Since I had come from Eastern Command, that responsibility was given to me. Of all the tours, I would rate the Eastern Command tour as the most complicated. The tour has to cover visits to the Command HQ at Kolkata, the Corps HQ at Sukna (West Bengal), Tezpur (Assam) and Dimapur (Nagaland), as well as the Eastern Air Command and Director General Assam Rifles (DGAR) at Shillong (Meghalaya). The Divisions and Brigades to be visited were in the states of Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland and Manipur. Given the poor air and road connectivity of the North East, organizing this tour was a logistician's nightmare. Conducting the Northern Command tour restricted to J & K was child's play in comparison. I benefited immensely from these tours, especially during my Brigade Command. I was surprised, therefore, to see that in the post-tour feedback, a number of students had written that the tour was a waste of time with little training value. I had to get the course together and share with them my experience and how such ill-considered feedback, just because they were 'soft' and couldn't handle the rigours of travelling, was not done, as it could jeopardize future tours. I gave them my own example and how much I had benefited from them. I think my point was well-taken because, after that, the feedback was more on professional and less on administrative matters.

After completing command of a Brigade, officers are selected to attend the National Defence College course at New Delhi. This is a very prestigious tri-service course, also attended by officers of the other Group A services. The nomination for the course happens in October during the Army Commanders' Conference for the course beginning on the first Monday of January of the following year. The SB 1, the promotion board

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